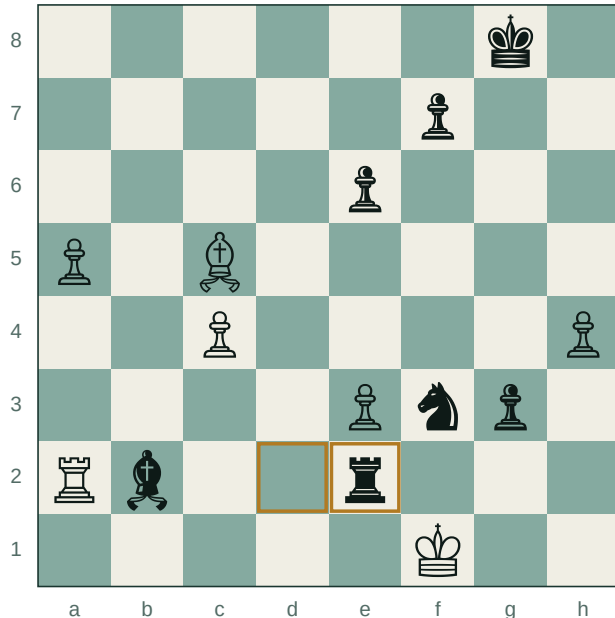


Quiet tactical moves: White, move 34

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 33...Rxe2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34. Kxe2 35. e4 Nd4+ 36. Kf2

34.Kxe2 The king captures the rook on e2. Recorded reply: **34...g2**.

35.e4 The pawn moves from e3 to e4. Recorded reply: **35...Nd4+**.

36.Kf2 The king moves from e2 to f2.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: knight on f3 and rook on e2. Check for tactical protection.